

Urgency-Scarcity

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Introduction

Welcome to 'Urgency-Scarcity', the sixth module in the Copywriting 101 course. In this module, we'll cover the importance of using urgency & scarcity to create action in your audience.

DISCLAIMER: I highly recommend watching every previous module before watching this module, as we'll be building on the concepts we learned there. If you don't understand those concepts in depth, applying the concepts you'll learn here will be harder and more complicated.

Link to the FULL video version: [Urgency-Scarcity Video](#)

Link to the mastersheet: [Copywriting Mastersheet](#)

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Cognitive Ease

Our brains prefer tasks that feel easy, smooth, and familiar. When something feels mentally effortful or complex, your brain subconsciously resists it.

> *We don't like hard stuff.*

Humans will naturally gravitate toward the path that requires the least cognitive and physical effort, even if it's not the best choice.

This is because the brain is a 'lazy optimizer.' It wants to conserve energy — it's a biological survival mechanism. Thinking hard burns glucose. So if something feels hard, your brain does anything to avoid it.

This also applies to making decisions.

EX: Making a big decision to invest thousands of dollars into a coaching program where you'll have to do more work.

Even if there's an action you know will benefit you, if it's hard, your brain will try to avoid it.

Our brain's favorite tool is procrastination — *I'll do it later OR I'll decide later.*

- > School exams
- > Outreach
- > Breaking up with gf
- > Firing people

Here's why procrastinating is such a favorable option for your brain.

1. You don't have to suffer the pain of 'doing' now. (*avoiding the pain of action*)
2. You trick yourself into thinking you'll do it later, so you'll still get the benefit of the action. (*avoiding the pain of inaction*)

This was the downfall of my college business career lol. I would procrastinate my end-of-term papers until the very last hour possible. Sometimes, even asking for an extension on the deadline.

Until I had no choice but to write the paper now or fail, was the only time I took action I needed to.

The same will happen in your marketing without the power of urgency and scarcity.

You must present them with a situation where they have to decide now.

You must help them face the awareness of their pain, not avoid it.

(Simple Example: 15% Off pop-up for first-time visitors if they give you their email.)

IMPORTANT: We're not 'forcing' someone to buy. We're helping them decide. There's a very big difference.

- > We want a 'yes' or 'no' — never 'maybe.'

That's what we'll cover in this module. How to help people make the tough decisions and take the hard actions that will benefit them.

The Psychology of Urgency-Scarcity

At their core, urgency and scarcity both stem from **loss aversion**.

- > Humans fear losing something more than they desire gaining it.

When time is running out or availability is disappearing, our brain throws a mini panic party. Rational thinking steps aside, and decisions get made faster, *usually emotionally*.

Urgency is about limited time — people feel pressure to act because the clock is ticking.

- > "If I don't do this now, I'll miss out."

Scarcity is about limited availability — people feel pressure to act because there's not enough to go around.

> *"If I don't act fast, it'll be gone."*

Let's go over the typical forms of **urgency** and **scarcity**.

Reminder: ALWAYS keep the first principles in mind. Make sure you're using the best form of urgency-scarcity for your situation, OR get creative by creating your own form for your situation.

Forms of Urgency (*limited time left to decide*)

Rolling Cohorts: A new group starts regularly, but if you miss this round, you gotta wait.

> *Next cohort starts June 15 — doors close this Friday at midnight.*

Seasonal Urgency: Only available during a specific time of year or tied to a seasonal event.

> *Our Summer Launch Bootcamp only runs once a year. Enroll by July 1st or wait until 2026.*

Pricing Urgency: The price increases after a specific deadline.

> *Join now for \$997 — price increases to \$1,500 in 48 hours.*

Exploding Opportunity: A rare, time-sensitive external advantage — act now or miss out forever.

> *Instagram's algorithm is favoring Reels in 2025. Learn how to dominate before the next update rolls out. (Think 'Gold Rush' vibes.)*

Bonus Urgency: Extra bonuses are only available for a limited time.

> *Enroll before Sunday to get a free 1-on-1 coaching session (\$500 value).*

Event-Based Urgency: Tied to a live event, launch, or webinar.

> *Registration closes when we go live on June 10th at 7PM EST.*

Countdown Timers (Visual Urgency): A literal ticking clock = panic clicks.

> *Only 03:26:14 left to enroll before this page expires.*

Fast-Action Urgency: Bonus or offer only for people who act within X minutes/hours of first seeing it.

> *If you enroll in the next 15 minutes, you'll get an exclusive bonus vault.*

External Deadline Urgency: Tied to a platform or tool that's expiring access.

> *Our Kajabi trial ends June 1st — we're shutting everything down after that.*

Personal Deadline Urgency (Self-Imposed): For use in 1:1 calls or email follow-ups.

> *I can reserve your spot until tomorrow, but after that, it'll open to the waitlist.*

Urgency + Emotional Leverage/Pain: Urgency can hit harder when it's PAIRED with an emotional pain or dream outcome.

> One way to do that is by using the 'Top of the mountain' vs 'Rock bottom' duality:

> Iman's Remote Revolution 2.0:

- Top Of The Mountain: *Owner of Your Own Future*
- Rock Bottom: *Owned by Others*
- Urgency w/ no emotion: *"Enroll before Friday to get \$100 off"*
- Urgency w/ emotion: *"If you're serious about not being told when to wake up, where to be, or how much you're worth — this is your chance. Enrollment closes Friday. After that, it's back to being owned by someone else's schedule."*

Forms of Scarcity (limited amount of stuff)

Limited Supply: Only a set number of spots, products, or units exist — once they're gone, that's it.

> *Only 30 hoodies available — once they're gone, they're gone.*

Limited Supply of Bonuses: Everyone can still join, but the special bonuses are only for the fastest movers.

> *First 10 buyers get access to the VIP mastermind. 3 spots left.*

Never Available Again: This version of the offer won't ever return — not even on Black Friday.

> *This is the last time we're offering this course live. After this, it'll only be available as a self-paced version — no interaction.*

Dripped Availability Scarcity: You release only a few seats/products each round.

> *Only 5 new client slots are opened each month.*

Tiered Scarcity: Different bonuses for the first X buyers, next Y buyers, etc.

> *First 10 get VIP access, next 20 get the replay package, then it's just the base course.*

Scarcity by Qualification: Not everyone gets access — you must apply or be approved.

> *We only accept students who pass our onboarding form and match our community standards.*

Time + Quantity Scarcity: Both a deadline and limited spots.

> *Doors close in 48 hours or when we hit 100 members — whichever comes first.*

Scarcity of Access or Support: You can buy anytime, but personalized access is limited.

> *This is the only time I'll be coaching live — future rounds will be self-paced only.*

Keys to Effective Urgency

1. **It must be real.**
 - a. People can smell fake deadlines.
 - b. Don't say "doors close at midnight" if they reopen every week.
2. **Use deadlines that actually matter.**
 - a. Tie urgency to real events (launches, seasons, price changes).
 - b. Show a countdown timer — visual pressure hits harder.
3. **Remind them frequently.**
 - a. Most people delay until the last second.
 - b. Use multiple touchpoints (email, SMS, ads) as the deadline nears.
4. **Combine with a reason why.**
 - a. Give a logical reason behind the deadline:
 - b. "We start group calls Monday — can't let people in late."

Keys to Effective Scarcity

1. **Be specific with numbers**
 - a. "Limited spots" is meh.
 - b. "Only 3 VIP slots left" is juicy.
2. **Make it visible**
 - a. Show a live counter, a struck-through bonus, or say:
 - b. "10 claimed out of 12 total — almost gone."
3. **Follow through**
 - a. If you say you're capping access, actually freaking cap it you goobers.
 - b. Scarcity only works if people believe it.
4. **Explain why it's limited**
 - a. Not just "to make you buy" — but legit reasons:

- b. "I can only coach 20 students at once to give proper support."

The Urgency-Scarcity Checklist

During editing, consider running your offer through this checklist:

1. *Is the urgency/scarcity real and specific?*
2. *Is there a clear reason why for the limitation?*
3. *Have I tied the urgency to a real-world consequence?*
4. *Have I made it visible (timer, counter, explicit numbers)?*
5. *Have I reinforced it across multiple touchpoints?*

KJ Ethical Urgency-Scarcity Example: (over \$90k+ in sales)

You're Still Early...
Lock-In Your Spot Now Before It's Too Late
This Is The Opportunity You Have Been Waiting For...

While this is the opportunity of a lifetime — there is one small problem...

The more people who have access to this information, the less valuable it becomes.

So to keep Digital Persuasion School as valuable as possible for each member...

I'm Going To RAISE The Price Of Digital Persuasion
School For Every 100 People That Join.

This will ensure 3 things:

- *Digital Persuasion School remains insanely valuable for each member.*
- *The community is full of ONLY the most high-quality entrepreneurs who are serious about learning this skill and using it to make lots of money online.*
- *You are rewarded for taking action NOW by locking in your access before you have to pay double.*

That being said...

Now Is Your Chance To Lock-In Your Spot For The Insanely Low Price Of \$97/Month

After the first 100 people join, it will never be this price again.

Click the button below to save your spot at \$97/month.

(Click Here To Save Your Spot Now)

Important Reminders

Urgency and scarcity aren't just tactics — **they're frames.** Your marketing message as a whole — the individual copy you've written, and the state of mind they're reading it in — all play into the amount of 'big/fomo' they're feeling.

> You can't just slap 'LIMITED TIME LEFT' on a page and make a million dollars. Using proper urgency and scarcity tactics should just be the 'cherry on top' of a great sales message.

With great power comes great responsibility. **Please. Please. Please, do not start lying/bending the truth in everything you write.**

Ephesians 4:14 (ESV)

> *"So that we may no longer be children, tossed to and fro by the waves and carried about by every wind of doctrine, by human cunning, by craftiness in deceitful schemes."*

2 Corinthians 4:2 (ESV)

> *"But we have renounced disgraceful, underhanded ways. We refuse to practice cunning or to tamper with God's word..."*

Genesis 3:1 (ESV)

> *"Now the serpent was more crafty than any other beast of the field that the Lord God had made."*

Romans 16:18 (ESV)

> *"For such persons do not serve our Lord Christ, but their own appetites, and by smooth talk and flattery they deceive the hearts of the naive."*

INSTEAD, USE TRUTH TO HELP PEOPLE TAKE ACTION TO CHANGE THEIR LIVES FOR THE BETTER!

Ephesians 4:15 (ESV)

> *"Rather, speaking the truth in love, we are to grow up in every way into him who is the head, into Christ."*

Quick Reminder:

If you want me to crank more modules like this one, and even better, let me know any wins/breakthroughs/thoughts you have on this module/course in the #★course-wins channel in the Discord. It gives me so much energy to know all the pain I go through making these is worth it haha. Love y'all and see you in the next module. ❤️ - KJ

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